

Paper 4, Option 4E: Judaism

Topics	What students need to learn	
1 Religious beliefs, values and teachings	1.1	Ethical monotheism a) Creator, and Sustainer of all creation; He alone is God, Oneness, no physical comparison whatsoever, alone worthy of worship; rewards and punishes. b) Obligations between people and obligations between humans and God. c) Interpretations across different Jewish traditions; provides a context to the beliefs across a range of Jewish traditions, significance in terms of being the essence and foundation of Judaism and for the community of believers. With reference to the ideas of D Cohn Sherbok and G Robinson.
	1.2	God reveals himself to his people in the Torah and in the Talmud a) Jews seen as the chosen people, obligations of the Jews as an example of living in accordance with God's will. b) Significance of revelation; preservation of Jewish identity, impacts on whole of life of the community. c) Status of Moses and the Ten Commandments, status of different covenants. With reference to the ideas of A Cohen and G Robinson.
	1.3	Interpretation of these beliefs and their impact on understanding the meaning and purpose of life and death across different traditions. The significance of these for an understanding of the distinctive features of Judaism today a) The nature of the soul. b) Life after death; spiritual and physical resurrection, judgment, heaven and She'ol/Gehenna (hell). c) Jewish thought on the meaning and purpose of life. With reference to the ideas of E Kaplan-Spitz and B L Weiss, and Y Buxbaum.

Topics	What students need to learn	
	1.4	Values (1) a) The relationship between revelation: Torah and values, dealing with every aspect of life (Ethics of the Fathers – context in Nezikin). b) Jewish values and universal values: Jewish distinctiveness as the People of the Almighty and the Noahide Code expressing universal values (Ethics of the Fathers – significance of gemiluth chasadim). c) The qualities of the Almighty and their reflection in the values of love, justice and holiness. God is the source of moral values. With reference to the ideas of G Robinson and M Kellner.